GRADE 6 ELA

Literature and Reading Comprehension

150 Multiple-Choice Questions

50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Skills covered

Theme and central idea; inference and textual evidence; plot and structure; character development; point of view; figurative language; imagery, tone, and mood; symbolism; author’s craft; comparing ideas; and evidence-based interpretation.

Aligned primarily to Common Core Grade 6 Literature standards (RL.6.1–RL.6.10). Original passages are included so students answer comprehension questions from the text rather than relying only on isolated recall.

Passage 1: The Lantern in the Window **(Realistic fiction)**

Every evening, Mara's grandfather placed a small brass lantern in the front window, even though the streetlights were bright enough to illuminate the entire block. Mara thought the habit was pointless. One rainy Thursday, she asked him why he bothered. He polished the lantern's glass before answering. “When I first moved here, I worked late at the bakery. Your great-grandmother left a light in the window so I could find my way home through the fog.” He paused, then added, “The bakery is gone, and she is gone, but I still know what that light means.” That night, Mara watched the lantern glow against the rain. The following evening, she placed a second candle beside it—not because the street was dark, but because she finally understood what the light remembered.

1. [Easy] Why does Grandfather place a lantern in the window?

A. It helps him read recipes after dark.

B. It warns neighbors when the bakery is open.

C. It keeps the streetlights from shining inside.

D. It reminds him of the light his great-grandmother left for him.

2. [Easy] How does Mara feel about the lantern at the beginning?

A. She thinks the habit is pointless.

B. She wants to sell it to a neighbor.

C. She is proud that she chose it.

D. She is frightened by its glow.

3. [Easy] What changes Mara's understanding of the lantern?

A. The streetlights suddenly stop working.

B. A neighbor complains about the light.

C. Mara discovers a new lantern in the attic.

D. Grandfather explains the memory connected to it.

4. [Easy] Which word best describes Grandfather's attitude toward the lantern?

A. Sentimental

B. Careless

C. Suspicious

D. Impatient

5. [Easy] What does Mara do at the end?

A. She adds a second candle beside the lantern.

B. She blows out the lantern.

C. She carries the lantern to the bakery.

D. She asks Grandfather to stop the habit.

6. [Medium] What is the most likely meaning of the lantern beyond its practical use?

A. It represents a contest between neighbors.

B. It represents memory and connection between generations.

C. It proves the street needs more lighting.

D. It shows that old objects are always valuable.

7. [Medium] Why does the author mention that the bakery and great-grandmother are gone?

A. To explain why Grandfather dislikes his neighborhood.

B. To show that the family has forgotten its history.

C. To show why the lantern has become a way of preserving the past.

D. To suggest Mara should open a bakery.

8. [Medium] Which event most directly causes Mara's change in perspective?

A. Seeing the rain hit the window.

B. Hearing Grandfather explain what the light means to him.

C. Finding the brass lantern in a drawer.

D. Noticing that the streetlights are bright.

9. [Medium] What theme is best supported by the passage?

A. People should abandon habits from the past.

B. A small tradition can carry a powerful personal meaning.

C. New technology always improves family life.

D. Memories are useful only when they solve problems.

10. [Medium] Why does Mara add a candle rather than simply agree with Grandfather?

A. She believes the lantern will not work in rain.

B. She is trying to hide the brass lantern.

C. She wants to make the street brighter than before.

D. Her action shows that she has begun to share in the tradition.

11. [Hard] How does the final sentence change the reader's understanding of Mara?

A. She becomes worried that the street is unsafe.

B. She decides that Grandfather's memory is inaccurate.

C. She learns that the lantern has a practical purpose only.

D. She moves from dismissing the ritual to choosing to participate in it.

12. [Hard] Which detail most strongly supports the idea that the lantern is symbolic?

A. Mara asks about the habit on Thursday.

B. The lantern is made of brass.

C. Grandfather says he still knows what the light means.

D. The streetlights illuminate the block.

13. [Hard] What is the effect of setting the conversation on a rainy evening?

A. It explains why the family cannot use electricity.

B. It proves the lantern can protect the house from storms.

C. The weather creates a scene in which the lantern's remembered purpose feels meaningful.

D. It makes Grandfather seem angry with Mara.

14. [Hard] Which statement best describes the passage's structure?

A. A mystery is introduced and solved by a stranger.

B. A historical event is described in chronological detail.

C. Mara's initial judgment is challenged by an explanation and resolved through action.

D. A family argument grows until the characters separate.

15. [Hard] Which inference is best supported about family traditions?

A. Traditions matter only to older family members.

B. Every tradition should be continued exactly as it began.

C. A tradition is meaningful only if it is useful to everyone.

D. Their meaning may become clearer when people learn the stories behind them.

Passage 2: The Last Seat **(Realistic fiction)**

When the school bus arrived, every seat seemed claimed. Theo spotted one empty place beside a girl who was new to the school, but he hurried toward the back, where his friends were laughing. The girl held her backpack tightly and stared out the window. At the next stop, an older student climbed aboard and found no seat. The driver asked everyone to make room. Theo's friends shifted reluctantly, and the older student squeezed in. Theo glanced at the new girl. She had not complained or asked for help. He remembered his own first week, when the names and hallways had felt like a maze. The next morning, he sat beside her. “I'm Theo,” he said. She smiled with relief. By Friday, she was laughing with the group at the back, and Theo had learned that welcoming someone did not require a grand gesture—just a choice made before it was too late.

16. [Easy] Why does Theo avoid the empty seat at first?

A. He wants to sit with his friends at the back.

B. He has promised to sit beside the driver.

C. He thinks the seat is broken.

D. He is afraid of missing his bus stop.

17. [Easy] What does the new girl do during the first bus ride?

A. She holds her backpack and looks out the window.

B. She tells everyone a joke.

C. She moves to the back and joins Theo's friends.

D. She argues with the driver.

18. [Easy] What memory helps Theo understand the girl's situation?

A. He remembers losing his backpack.

B. He remembers feeling lost during his own first week.

C. He remembers being late for a sports game.

D. He remembers riding a bus to another town.

19. [Easy] What does Theo do the next morning?

A. He tells his friends to ignore her.

B. He saves his seat for an older student.

C. He sits beside the new girl and introduces himself.

D. He asks the driver to change the route.

20. [Easy] How does the new girl respond when Theo introduces himself?

A. She immediately leaves the bus.

B. She smiles with relief.

C. She becomes angry.

D. She pretends not to hear him.

21. [Medium] What does the empty seat represent in the story?

A. A sign that the bus route should change.

B. A problem that only the bus driver can solve.

C. An opportunity to include someone who may feel left out.

D. A reward for the most popular student.

22. [Medium] Why does the author mention that the girl does not ask for help?

A. To suggest that she does not want any friends.

B. To show that people may need kindness even when they do not request it.

C. To prove she is too shy to speak at school.

D. To show that the driver has ignored her.

23. [Medium] Which choice best describes Theo's change?

A. He becomes less interested in his friends.

B. He shifts from choosing convenience to taking a small, considerate action.

C. He decides never to sit at the back again.

D. He learns that new students should travel alone.

24. [Medium] What is the central message of the story?

A. Friendship depends on being popular.

B. New students must ask directly for every kind of help.

C. People should always sit in the same place.

D. A simple act of welcome can help someone feel they belong.

25. [Medium] Why does the story end by noting that Theo learned something?

A. It suggests Theo regrets making a friend.

B. It shows that the girl has become the narrator.

C. It explains why the bus route ends on Friday.

D. It highlights that kindness can teach the person offering it, too.

26. [Hard] Which detail best shows that Theo's decision is influenced by empathy?

A. He recalls how confusing his own first week felt.

B. The bus driver asks everyone to make room.

C. His friends are laughing at the back.

D. The girl looks out the window.

27. [Hard] How does the author use contrast to develop the theme?

A. The girl arrives early, but Theo arrives late.

B. The bus is crowded, but the school is empty.

C. Theo first chooses his friends, then chooses to approach the isolated girl.

D. The driver speaks loudly, while Theo speaks silently.

28. [Hard] What can be inferred about the girl's experience by Friday?

A. She dislikes Theo's friends more than before.

B. She plans to change schools immediately.

C. She no longer rides the bus.

D. She feels more comfortable and has begun connecting with others.

29. [Hard] Which statement is the strongest evaluation of Theo's action?

A. It matters because it solves every difficulty at school.

B. It matters because it makes him the bus driver's favorite.

C. It matters because he abandons all his old friends.

D. It matters because he acts without waiting for the girl to ask.

30. [Hard] What is the effect of ending with a lesson rather than a dramatic event?

A. It turns the story into a mystery.

B. It shifts the focus to the bus driver's career.

C. It suggests the earlier events were imaginary.

D. It reinforces the quiet, everyday nature of meaningful inclusion.

Passage 3: A Map of Wind (Poetry)

The wind draws maps across the lake, / then rubs each silver line away. / It lifts the leaves, turns boats to face / the far-off edge of yesterday. / No hand can hold its shifting road, / no fence can make it stay; / yet every sail and spinning seed / can show the wind's brief way. / I cannot see the wind itself, / but watch what it sets free: / a kite, a cloud, a field of grass— / its moving signature to me.

31. [Easy] What does the speaker say the wind does to the lake?

A. It builds a fence along the shore.

B. It paints permanent marks on the water.

C. It freezes the lake into a road.

D. It draws lines and then rubs them away.

32. [Easy] Which object is named as something the wind can move?

A. A mountain

B. A clock

C. A stone wall

D. A kite

33. [Easy] Can the speaker see the wind itself?

A. Yes, only when it blows at night.

B. Yes, as a bright ribbon in the sky.

C. No, because the wind never moves anything.

D. No, but the speaker can see what it moves.

34. [Easy] What is a “spinning seed” an example of in the poem?

A. Something that stops the wind.

B. Something whose movement reveals the wind.

C. A plant that grows under water.

D. A tool used to measure the lake.

35. [Easy] Which word best describes the wind in the poem?

A. Motionless

B. Unseen

C. Predictable

D. Silent and powerless

36. [Medium] What does “its moving signature” suggest?

A. The speaker knows the wind personally.

B. The wind leaves recognizable effects even though it cannot be seen.

C. The wind always travels in one direction.

D. The wind writes its name on paper.

37. [Medium] Why does the poet describe the lake's silver lines?

A. To suggest that the water is polluted.

B. To show that the lake is made of metal.

C. To explain how maps are printed.

D. To help readers picture temporary patterns made by the wind.

38. [Medium] What is the poem's main idea?

A. Maps are more reliable than memories.

B. Nature should be controlled by fences.

C. The strongest things are always visible.

D. Something invisible can be understood through its effects.

39. [Medium] How does the repetition of examples such as a kite, cloud, and grass support the poem?

A. It proves that all objects move at the same speed.

B. It changes the poem into a set of instructions.

C. It gives several ways to observe the wind's influence.

D. It lists objects that can stop a storm.

40. [Medium] Which pair best captures the contrast in the poem?

A. The lake is warm, but the mountain is cold.

B. The seed is heavy, but the cloud is dark.

C. The speaker is indoors, but the kite is broken.

D. The wind cannot be seen, but its effects can be observed.

41. [Hard] What is the effect of describing the wind as drawing and rubbing out lines?

A. It presents nature as an artist whose work is temporary.

B. It makes the wind seem unable to move anything.

C. It suggests the lake is a written document.

D. It explains why people should avoid lakes.

42. [Hard] Which interpretation is best supported by the poem's final lines?

A. The wind controls every choice people make.

B. A signature must be written by hand to be real.

C. We often recognize unseen forces by the changes they create.

D. Only objects that move quickly are important.

43. [Hard] How does the poem's structure help develop its idea?

A. It compares two speakers who disagree about a rule.

B. It gives directions for building a kite.

C. It tells a story in which a storm damages a village.

D. It moves from examples of wind's actions to a reflection on how we recognize it.

44. [Hard] What does the phrase “far-off edge of yesterday” most likely suggest?

A. The wind can make the familiar world feel open to distance and change.

B. The boats are traveling into the past literally.

C. The lake has no shore or boundary.

D. The speaker has forgotten where the lake is.

45. [Hard] Which statement best evaluates the poet's use of concrete images?

A. The images make an abstract force understandable through things readers can picture.

B. The images prove the speaker can control the weather.

C. The images distract from the poem's subject entirely.

D. The images are included mainly to establish a historical date.

Passage 4: The Glass Mountain (Folktale)

A village stood below a mountain that shone like glass at sunrise. According to an old tale, anyone who reached its summit could ask one question and receive a truthful answer. Many wealthy travelers hired guides and carried heavy packs of food, but they turned back when the path grew steep. Lina, a shepherd's daughter, brought only water and a small bell. She stopped often to help a tired goat and to clear loose stones from the trail. Near the summit, she found an injured traveler and used her last bandage on his ankle. By the time she reached the top, the sun was setting. A voice asked, “What do you seek?” Lina thought of asking how to become rich, but instead asked, “What makes a person worthy of trust?” The mountain answered, “The choices made when no reward is promised.” Lina descended without gold or treasure. Yet when she returned, villagers began asking her to settle disputes, because they had seen the choices she made on the climb.

46. [Easy] What special quality is the Glass Mountain believed to have?

A. It grants every visitor a bag of gold.

B. It gives a truthful answer to one question asked at its summit.

C. It makes the village invisible at sunrise.

D. It turns anyone who climbs it into a ruler.

47. [Easy] What does Lina bring on her climb?

A. Water and a small bell

B. A cart full of food

C. A silver crown and a map

D. A heavy chest of coins

48. [Easy] Whom does Lina help near the summit?

A. A group of village guards

B. A lost king

C. A wealthy merchant with a broken cart

D. An injured traveler

49. [Easy] What question does Lina finally ask the mountain?

A. Where is a hidden treasure buried?

B. How can she make the mountain shorter?

C. How can she become the richest person?

D. What makes a person worthy of trust?

50. [Easy] What happens when Lina returns to the village?

A. She is given a chest of gold.

B. She leaves to search for another mountain.

C. She refuses to speak to anyone.

D. Villagers begin asking her to settle disputes.

51. [Medium] Why do many wealthy travelers turn back?

A. They learn that the village has moved away.

B. They discover that the mountain has no summit.

C. They rely on heavy supplies and guides but struggle when the path becomes steep.

D. They are forbidden to ask the mountain a question.

52. [Medium] What does Lina's use of her last bandage reveal?

A. She has forgotten why she climbed.

B. She hopes the traveler will pay her.

C. She wants to avoid reaching the summit.

D. She values helping someone even when it costs her something.

53. [Medium] What is the tale's main theme?

A. Trust is earned through choices, not promised rewards.

B. People should never ask questions.

C. A difficult journey is worthwhile only if it brings treasure.

D. Wealth always guarantees wisdom.

54. [Medium] Why does Lina consider asking how to become rich but choose another question?

A. She knows the mountain cannot answer questions about money.

B. Her priorities focus on trust rather than personal wealth.

C. She has already found enough gold on the path.

D. She wants to make the traveler wealthy instead.

55. [Medium] How does the villagers' response support the mountain's answer?

A. They trust Lina because they have observed her helpful choices.

B. They trust her because she tells them to do so.

C. They believe the mountain has made her a queen.

D. They trust her because she returns with treasure.

56. [Hard] How does the tale challenge the idea that success comes from wealth?

A. It states that the village needs a larger market.

B. The wealthy travelers fail, while Lina gains trust through her actions.

C. It shows that only wealthy people can reach high places.

D. It suggests money is the only way to help strangers.

57. [Hard] What is the significance of Lina's small bell?

A. It helps characterize her as traveling lightly rather than relying on expensive supplies.

B. It is revealed to be the source of the mountain's magic.

C. It proves she has already climbed the mountain before.

D. It allows her to command the injured traveler.

58. [Hard] Which event most clearly foreshadows Lina's later role in the village?

A. The sun begins to set near the summit.

B. Travelers hire guides before leaving.

C. The mountain shines at sunrise.

D. She repeatedly helps others along the path.

59. [Hard] What does the ending imply about the relationship between character and reputation?

A. A good reputation depends on receiving a prize.

B. Reputation is determined only by family background.

C. People's observed actions can create trust more effectively than claims can.

D. People trust anyone who returns from a journey.

60. [Hard] Which statement best describes the tale's resolution?

A. Lina becomes wealthy and leaves the village forever.

B. Lina discovers that the mountain's promise was a trick.

C. Lina receives no material prize, but her conduct earns her a valued place in the community.

D. Lina learns that helping others prevents all future problems.

Passage 5: The Empty Stage **(Realistic fiction)**

Niko had memorized every line for the school play, yet when he stepped beneath the stage lights, the audience seemed to stretch to the farthest wall. His mouth went dry. He stared at the first line on the page in his hand and could not speak. From the wings, Amara whispered the opening words. Niko repeated them, then found the next line, and the next. After the performance, he apologized to the cast for freezing. Amara shook her head. “You kept going,” she said. “That matters more than a perfect start.” Niko knew he had made mistakes, but he also knew that he had stayed onstage. The next week, he volunteered to read announcements over the school intercom. His voice trembled at first, then steadied as he reached the final sentence.

61. [Easy] What happens when Niko steps beneath the stage lights?

A. He forgets where the stage is.

B. He walks off before the play begins.

C. He becomes unable to speak at first.

D. He asks the audience to leave.

62. [Easy] Who whispers the opening words to Niko?

A. His teacher

B. The director

C. Amara

D. A member of the audience

63. [Easy] What does Niko do after the performance?

A. He throws away the script.

B. He refuses to talk to Amara.

C. He quits every school activity.

D. He apologizes to the cast for freezing.

64. [Easy] What does Niko volunteer to do the following week?

A. Direct the next school play.

B. Read announcements over the school intercom.

C. Paint the stage scenery.

D. Sell tickets for another play.

65. [Easy] How does Niko's voice change during the announcement?

A. It trembles at first and then steadies.

B. It grows quieter until no one can hear.

C. It never changes.

D. It becomes angry and loud.

66. [Medium] What does Amara mean when she says, “You kept going”?

A. She wants Niko to memorize more lines.

B. She values Niko's persistence more than a flawless performance.

C. She believes the audience did not notice him.

D. She thinks Niko should have stopped earlier.

67. [Medium] What is a central theme of the passage?

A. Courage can mean continuing even after a difficult start.

B. People should avoid tasks that make them nervous.

C. Only perfect performances deserve praise.

D. Fear disappears immediately when people try something.

68. [Medium] Why is the intercom announcement important to the ending?

A. It suggests he no longer remembers the play.

B. It shows Niko choosing another chance to practise despite his fear.

C. It explains why Amara leaves the cast.

D. It proves he has become the school's best actor.

69. [Medium] Which trait does Niko show by volunteering again?

A. Carelessness

B. Perseverance

C. Jealousy

D. Dishonesty

70. [Medium] How does Amara affect Niko's response to his mistake?

A. She tells him to blame the audience.

B. She convinces him that mistakes do not matter at all.

C. She reframes the experience as persistence rather than failure.

D. She insists that he leave the school play.

71. [Hard] How does the author develop Niko's confidence across the passage?

A. Niko avoids speaking until the final paragraph.

B. Niko receives a prize that removes all his worries.

C. Niko moves from freezing onstage to speaking again in a different public setting.

D. Niko learns that the play was canceled.

72. [Hard] Why does the author include Niko's admission that he made mistakes?

A. It shows that Amara caused the performance problem.

B. It proves the script was written incorrectly.

C. It makes his progress realistic and emphasizes effort rather than perfection.

D. It suggests the audience demanded a refund.

73. [Hard] Which inference about Amara is best supported?

A. She is supportive and notices the value of persistence.

B. She is upset that Niko receives attention.

C. She wants to take Niko's role in the play.

D. She believes public speaking is easy for everyone.

74. [Hard] What is the effect of the trembling voice in the final sentence?

A. It suggests Niko has forgotten the announcement.

B. It shows that growth can happen while some nervousness remains.

C. It shifts the setting back to the theater.

D. It proves he is less confident than before.

75. [Hard] Which statement best expresses the passage's view of bravery?

A. Bravery requires hiding every mistake.

B. Bravery means never feeling fear.

C. Bravery can involve acting while fear is still present.

D. Bravery is possible only after winning a competition.

Passage 6: The Clockmaker's Apprentice **(Historical fiction)**

In the workshop, every clock ticked at a slightly different pace. Master Ivo could hear a flaw in a gear before he opened the case, but his apprentice, Ren, could not. Ren tried to work faster, hoping speed would impress the master. Instead, he bent a delicate spring and lost an entire afternoon repairing the damage. Ivo said nothing; he placed a broken pocket watch beside Ren's tools. “Tell me what you notice,” he said. Ren wanted to answer quickly, but forced himself to listen. Beneath the uneven ticking, he heard a faint scrape. He examined the gears and found a tiny piece of grit. When the watch ran smoothly again, Ivo nodded. “Patience is not the opposite of skill,” he said. “It is how skill learns to see.” Ren began keeping a notebook of sounds, faults, and repairs. Months later, he could identify many problems before lifting a tool.

76. [Easy] What skill does Master Ivo have?

A. He can predict the weather by looking at clocks.

B. He can build clocks without any tools.

C. He can make every clock run at the same pace.

D. He can hear flaws in a clock's gear before opening it.

77. [Easy] Why does Ren try to work faster?

A. He wants to leave the workshop early.

B. He hopes speed will impress the master.

C. He is afraid of the clocks' sounds.

D. He has been ordered to finish a race.

78. [Easy] What mistake does Ren make?

A. He bends a delicate spring.

B. He paints the watch face blue.

C. He loses the workshop key.

D. He breaks a window with a hammer.

79. [Easy] What does Ren hear when he finally listens carefully?

A. A bell ringing in the village square.

B. A bird singing outside the window.

C. A faint scrape beneath the uneven ticking.

D. A voice calling from the street.

80. [Easy] What does Ren begin keeping after repairing the watch?

A. A notebook of sounds, faults, and repairs.

B. A list of customers' favorite colors.

C. A collection of broken springs only.

D. A diary about traveling merchants.

81. [Medium] What does Ivo's statement about patience suggest?

A. Skill depends only on having expensive tools.

B. Careful observation is an important part of developing expertise.

C. Patience matters only when a clock is broken.

D. Fast work is always better than careful work.

82. [Medium] Why does Ivo place a broken pocket watch beside Ren's tools?

A. He wants Ren to sell the watch immediately.

B. He wants Ren to copy the watch's design without testing it.

C. He is punishing Ren by taking away all his tools.

D. He gives Ren a chance to practise noticing rather than simply telling him the answer.

83. [Medium] How does Ren change?

A. He decides clocks are impossible to repair.

B. He learns to observe carefully instead of relying on speed.

C. He stops asking questions and avoids difficult tasks.

D. He becomes less interested in learning.

84. [Medium] What does the uneven ticking contribute to the story?

A. It signals that the master has left the building.

B. It proves that every clock is designed badly.

C. It provides a clue that Ren must learn to notice.

D. It makes the workshop too noisy to work in.

85. [Medium] Which theme is best supported?

A. Tools matter more than observation.

B. Careful attention turns experience into skill.

C. Learning is fastest when no one gives feedback.

D. A person should hide every mistake.

86. [Hard] How does the notebook contribute to the passage's resolution?

A. It allows Ren to avoid listening to the clocks.

B. It proves Ivo has retired from the workshop.

C. It replaces the need to repair clocks.

D. It shows Ren turning one lesson into a lasting learning practice.

87. [Hard] Which contrast drives Ren's development?

A. He fears the master but later refuses to listen to him.

B. He prefers old clocks but later prefers new ones.

C. He wants to work alone but later opens a shop.

D. He begins by valuing speed but learns to value close observation.

88. [Hard] What does the phrase “how skill learns to see” mean in context?

A. Expertise grows when a person learns to notice details that were previously missed.

B. Repairing clocks requires no practice.

C. People can learn only by reading written instructions.

D. Skill gives a person perfect eyesight.

89. [Hard] Which detail best supports the inference that Ren is becoming more independent?

A. Ren bends a spring early in the story.

B. The clocks tick at different paces.

C. Months later, he can identify many problems before lifting a tool.

D. Ivo places the watch beside Ren's tools.

90. [Hard] How does the author use the workshop setting to develop the theme?

A. The workshop is presented as a place where speed is always rewarded.

B. The tiny sounds and delicate parts make careful attention essential to success.

C. The setting shows that learning happens only in quiet places.

D. The clocks create a magical threat that Ren must defeat.

Passage 7: The River's Argument (Poetry)

The river says, “I never stop; / I carve the stone and shape the shore.” / The mountain answers, “Still I stand; / I have been here and will be more.” / The river laughs around its bends; / the mountain wears the winter's snow. / Each claims its way is strongest, yet / both change the world below. / The river carries seeds downstream; / the mountain gathers rain. / One moves, one holds, and neither acts / entirely alone again.

91. [Easy] What does the river say it can do?

A. Carve stone and shape the shore.

B. Keep every seed from traveling.

C. Cover the mountain with snow.

D. Hold the rain in one place forever.

92. [Easy] What does the mountain claim about itself?

A. It can carry seeds downstream.

B. It has stood for a long time and will continue to stand.

C. It can flow around bends.

D. It can change direction every hour.

93. [Easy] What does the river carry downstream?

A. Clocks

B. Lanterns

C. Books

D. Seeds

94. [Easy] What does the mountain gather?

A. Rain

B. Paper

C. Sandwiches

D. Paint

95. [Easy] What do both the river and mountain do?

A. They change the world below.

B. They compete in a race.

C. They speak to the village children.

D. They disappear every winter.

96. [Medium] What conflict is presented in the poem?

A. The speakers argue about who owns the village.

B. The river and mountain each claim that its way is strongest.

C. The mountain tries to stop the rain from falling.

D. The river tries to climb the mountain.

97. [Medium] What does the ending suggest about strength?

A. Only moving things can create change.

B. The strongest force never changes anything.

C. Different kinds of strength can work together and both matter.

D. Stillness is always better than movement.

98. [Medium] How does personification affect the poem?

A. It removes the contrast between the two forces.

B. It turns the poem into a scientific report.

C. It makes natural features seem like speakers defending their views.

D. It proves the river and mountain are human beings.

99. [Medium] Which line best supports the idea that both forces contribute?

A. “The river says, ‘I never stop’”

B. “One moves, one holds, and neither acts / entirely alone again.”

C. “The mountain wears the winter's snow.”

D. “The river laughs around its bends”

100. [Medium] What is the relationship between the river and mountain by the end?

A. They stop affecting the land entirely.

B. Their different actions are shown as connected rather than fully separate.

C. They agree that neither has any strength.

D. One is declared the winner and the other disappears.

101. [Hard] How does the poem's dialogue shape its central idea?

A. Each voice presents one kind of strength before the ending connects them.

B. The dialogue introduces a third speaker who resolves a crime.

C. The dialogue proves the river has a more reliable memory.

D. The dialogue provides directions for traveling safely.

102. [Hard] What is the effect of pairing movement with stillness?

A. It suggests that nature is always in conflict without purpose.

B. It makes the poem focus only on weather.

C. It proves that the mountain will eventually move faster than the river.

D. It shows that change can result from both action and stability.

103. [Hard] Which interpretation of “both change the world below” is best supported?

A. The world below is completely separate from natural forces.

B. Influence can take different forms, even when it is not equally visible.

C. The mountain and river are competing to destroy the village.

D. Only the river has an effect on the landscape.

104. [Hard] Why does the poet avoid declaring a winner?

A. The poem's message depends on recognizing the value of both forces.

B. The mountain refuses to answer the river.

C. The poem is unfinished and has no central idea.

D. The poet has forgotten which speaker began the argument.

105. [Hard] Which statement best evaluates the poem's argument?

A. It challenges a single definition of strength by showing complementary roles.

B. It argues that all disagreements should end in defeat.

C. It shows that natural forces cannot affect one another.

D. It claims that strength is measured only by speed.

Passage 8: The Borrowed Jacket (Realistic fiction)

A cold wind swept the playground, and Jessa wished she had brought a coat. Her classmate Malik offered his extra jacket, though he would have to wait outside for the late bus. Jessa almost refused because she did not want to inconvenience him. Malik shrugged. “My bus is late every Tuesday. I can manage.” She accepted the jacket and promised to return it the next morning. Overnight, a button came loose. Jessa considered hiding the problem, but instead she told Malik and brought the jacket to her grandmother, who showed her how to sew it back on. Malik checked the button, then grinned. “Now it has a repair story.” Jessa returned the jacket clean and neatly folded. Later that month, when Malik forgot his lunch, Jessa shared hers without making a show of it. Neither mentioned the jacket again, but both remembered it.

106. [Easy] Why does Jessa want a coat?

A. She is planning to swim.

B. She wants to hide from the bus driver.

C. A cold wind is sweeping the playground.

D. She has spilled paint on her shirt.

107. [Easy] Who offers Jessa an extra jacket?

A. Ren

B. Suri

C. Theo

D. Malik

108. [Easy] What problem does Jessa notice about the jacket?

A. A button has come loose.

B. The sleeves are missing.

C. The zipper is locked.

D. The jacket is covered in blue paint.

109. [Easy] Who teaches Jessa how to sew the button back on?

A. Her teacher

B. Malik's older brother

C. Her grandmother

D. The bus driver

110. [Easy] What does Jessa do later when Malik forgets his lunch?

A. She shares hers with him.

B. She tells him to buy another lunch.

C. She hides her lunch in her backpack.

D. She asks the teacher to punish him.

111. [Medium] Why does Jessa initially almost refuse the jacket?

A. She does not want Malik to be inconvenienced.

B. She believes Malik is trying to trick her.

C. She dislikes the jacket's color.

D. She thinks jackets are not allowed at school.

112. [Medium] What does Jessa's decision to tell Malik about the button reveal?

A. She believes the jacket cannot be repaired.

B. She wants Malik to replace the jacket with a new one.

C. She chooses honesty instead of hiding a small problem.

D. She wants to avoid returning the jacket.

113. [Medium] What is the likely meaning of Malik's phrase “a repair story”?

A. The button was never actually damaged.

B. Malik plans to write a complaint about Jessa.

C. The repaired button becomes a reminder of the care involved in their friendship.

D. The jacket should be sold as a storybook.

114. [Medium] How does the jacket influence the relationship between Jessa and Malik?

A. It makes them compete to own the warmest clothes.

B. It causes them to stop speaking to each other.

C. It begins an exchange of help that continues in another form.

D. It leads them to argue about the bus schedule.

115. [Medium] Which theme is best supported?

A. People should never borrow anything.

B. Kindness can create a quiet cycle of mutual care.

C. Honesty is needed only when a mistake is large.

D. Friends must keep a record of every favor.

116. [Hard] Why does the author say neither mentions the jacket again?

A. Their later kindness shows the friendship has grown beyond keeping score.

B. They disagree about who owns the jacket.

C. They have both forgotten what happened.

D. They want to pretend the jacket never existed.

117. [Hard] Which detail best shows that Jessa takes responsibility?

A. She almost refuses the jacket.

B. She tells Malik about the loose button and gets help repairing it.

C. The wind sweeps across the playground.

D. Malik says his bus is late every Tuesday.

118. [Hard] How does the jacket function as a symbol?

A. It represents wealth and social status.

B. It represents a rule that everyone must share clothing.

C. It represents care that is passed between people rather than repaid exactly.

D. It represents Jessa's desire to avoid school.

119. [Hard] What can be inferred about Malik's character?

A. He helps without making the favor seem like a debt.

B. He expects Jessa to repay him immediately.

C. He dislikes sharing his belongings.

D. He wants other students to admire him.

120. [Hard] Which statement best describes the story's ending?

A. Jessa wins a prize for repairing the jacket.

B. Malik refuses Jessa's lunch and ends the friendship.

C. The characters continue helping one another without demanding recognition.

D. The jacket becomes more important than their friendship.

Passage 9: The Paper Bridge (Realistic fiction)

For the engineering fair, Suri's team had to build a bridge from paper and tape that could hold a stack of books. Suri wanted to make a wide, flat platform. Her teammate Ben argued for folded beams, but Suri dismissed the idea as too complicated. Their first bridge sagged under a single book. Instead of blaming Ben, Suri asked him to explain his design. They folded paper into triangular supports and tested different distances between them. Each test taught them something: a narrow base twisted, while widely spaced supports wasted material. Their final bridge held twelve books before bending. Another team held fifteen, so Suri's group did not win first prize. Still, Suri displayed their test notes beside the bridge. “The strongest part wasn't the paper,” she told the judges. “It was changing our minds when the evidence changed.”

121. [Easy] What materials must Suri's team use to build the bridge?

A. Paper and tape

B. Wood and nails

C. Plastic and string

D. Metal rods and glue

122. [Easy] What happens to the team's first bridge?

A. It holds twenty books.

B. It breaks before they build it.

C. It floats away in a stream.

D. It sags under a single book.

123. [Easy] What does Ben suggest using?

A. A wide sheet of metal

B. A thick glass platform

C. A wooden plank

D. Folded beams

124. [Easy] How many books does the final bridge hold before bending?

A. One

B. Fifty

C. Twelve

D. Five

125. [Easy] Does Suri's team win first prize?

A. Yes, because their bridge is the lightest.

B. No, because they forget to bring a bridge.

C. No; another team holds more books.

D. Yes, because they finish first.

126. [Medium] Why does Suri ask Ben to explain his design after the first test?

A. She plans to quit the fair.

B. She wants Ben to take all the blame.

C. She becomes willing to learn from an idea she had dismissed.

D. She wants to copy another team's finished bridge.

127. [Medium] What does the team learn from testing different support distances?

A. Paper cannot support any weight.

B. Design choices have trade-offs that can be studied through evidence.

C. The widest bridge is always strongest.

D. Testing is less useful than guessing.

128. [Medium] What is the main theme of the passage?

A. The first idea is usually the best one.

B. Winning is the only useful result of a project.

C. Progress depends on learning from evidence and revising ideas.

D. Teams work best when one person makes every decision.

129. [Medium] Why do Suri's teammates display their test notes?

A. They want the judges to ignore the bridge.

B. They want to show the learning behind their final design.

C. They want to prove the other team cheated.

D. They have no bridge to display.

130. [Medium] Which trait does Suri develop?

A. Impatience

B. Indifference

C. Arrogance

D. Open-mindedness

131. [Hard] What is the significance of the line about changing their minds when evidence changed?

A. It suggests the team changed its goal to avoid judging.

B. It proves that every test produced the same result.

C. It means the team no longer cared about the bridge.

D. It summarizes the team's shift from defending an idea to using results to guide decisions.

132. [Hard] How does the competition result affect the passage's message?

A. It shows that teamwork prevents all failure.

B. It proves that the judges misunderstood the rules.

C. It suggests that the team's design was actually the strongest.

D. The team learns something valuable even without winning.

133. [Hard] Which detail best supports the idea that experimentation is iterative?

A. The team tests support spacing and adjusts the design based on results.

B. Suri wants a wide, flat platform at first.

C. Another team holds fifteen books.

D. The fair requires paper and tape.

134. [Hard] How does Suri's initial dismissal of Ben's idea contribute to the story?

A. It explains why the judges cancel the fair.

B. It shows that folded beams are impossible to use.

C. It proves Ben is unwilling to cooperate.

D. It establishes a flaw in her approach that she later corrects.

135. [Hard] Which conclusion is best supported by the team's experience?

A. Complicated ideas should always be rejected.

B. A failed test can provide information that improves a later design.

C. A project is unsuccessful unless it wins first prize.

D. Evidence matters only when it supports the first idea.

Passage 10: The Fox and the Painted Tail (Fable)

A fox found a pot of blue paint beside a village wall. He dipped the tip of his tail into it and announced that he was a rare creature whose blue mark gave him special wisdom. The other animals asked him to settle arguments and predict the weather. At first, the fox guessed carefully. Soon he enjoyed the attention and began inventing answers. When a storm flooded the meadow, the animals lost their stores of grain because the fox had promised sunshine. A young hare asked why the fox had not warned them. The fox blamed the clouds, but rain washed the paint from his tail. The animals saw that the supposed mark of wisdom had been only color. Afterward, they listened more closely to those who explained their reasons and admitted when they were unsure.

136. [Easy] What does the fox put on the tip of his tail?

A. Red ribbon

B. Blue paint

C. Green leaves

D. Gold dust

137. [Easy] What does the fox claim the blue mark gives him?

A. Special wisdom

B. A royal title

C. The ability to fly

D. A perfect memory

138. [Easy] What happens when the storm floods the meadow?

A. The animals lose their stores of grain.

B. The meadow turns into a mountain.

C. The animals discover a treasure chest.

D. The fox becomes king.

139. [Easy] Who questions the fox after the storm?

A. A shepherd

B. A clockmaker

C. A young hare

D. A village baker

140. [Easy] What happens to the paint on the fox's tail?

A. The fox removes it with a brush.

B. It turns into gold.

C. Rain washes it away.

D. It becomes permanent.

141. [Medium] Why do the animals begin asking the fox for advice?

A. They have watched him accurately predict every storm for years.

B. He is the only animal who can store grain.

C. They believe his painted tail is proof of special wisdom.

D. He has been elected as the meadow's official leader.

142. [Medium] What mistake does the fox make after receiving attention?

A. He begins inventing answers instead of making careful guesses.

B. He admits the truth before anyone asks.

C. He gives away all the grain in the meadow.

D. He stops speaking to the animals entirely.

143. [Medium] What is the fable's central lesson?

A. People should trust the most confident speaker.

B. A colorful appearance always signals talent.

C. Weather can be controlled by making predictions.

D. Claims of wisdom should be judged by reasons and actions, not appearances.

144. [Medium] Why is the rain important to the plot?

A. It makes the animals forget their lost grain.

B. It removes the false sign and exposes the fox's deception.

C. It gives the fox time to invent a better story.

D. It proves that the fox can control storms.

145. [Medium] How do the animals change at the end?

A. They believe the fox even more than before.

B. They listen more carefully to people who explain their reasoning and admit uncertainty.

C. They decide to trust every new claim.

D. They stop asking anyone for advice.

146. [Hard] What does the blue paint symbolize?

A. A misleading outward sign that others mistake for genuine knowledge.

B. A warning that storms are approaching.

C. A natural ability shared by all animals.

D. A lasting reward for honesty.

147. [Hard] How does the young hare contribute to the moral?

A. The hare secretly paints the fox's tail again.

B. The hare asks a question that exposes the gap between the fox's claims and results.

C. The hare predicts the storm more accurately than anyone.

D. The hare convinces the animals to hide the grain.

148. [Hard] Which contrast is most important to the fable?

A. The fox appears wise but lacks reliable knowledge and honesty.

B. The hare is large while the fox is small.

C. The meadow is dry while the village is crowded.

D. The fox speaks softly while the hare shouts.

149. [Hard] Why does the author include the fox blaming the clouds?

A. It shows that he avoids responsibility rather than admitting his false claims.

B. It proves the clouds can understand animal speech.

C. It shows that the storm was caused by the fox.

D. It suggests the animals did not lose any grain.

150. [Hard] Which modern situation best matches the fable's lesson?

A. A farmer stores grain before the rainy season.

B. A person should check the evidence behind an online claim before trusting its confident presentation.

C. A student practises a skill until becoming more accurate.

D. A reader chooses a book because its cover is blue.

Answer Key

Answers correspond to the final randomized option order.

Easy

1. D 2. A 3. D 4. A 5. A 16. A 17. A 18. B 19. C 20. B

31. D 32. D 33. D 34. B 35. B 46. B 47. A 48. D 49. D 50. D

61. C 62. C 63. D 64. B 65. A 76. D 77. B 78. A 79. C 80. A

91. A 92. B 93. D 94. A 95. A 106. C 107. D 108. A 109. C 110. A

121. A 122. D 123. D 124. C 125. C 136. B 137. A 138. A 139. C 140. C

Medium

6. B 7. C 8. B 9. B 10. D 21. C 22. B 23. B 24. D 25. D

36. B 37. D 38. D 39. C 40. D 51. C 52. D 53. A 54. B 55. A

66. B 67. A 68. B 69. B 70. C 81. B 82. D 83. B 84. C 85. B

96. B 97. C 98. C 99. B 100. B 111. A 112. C 113. C 114. C 115. B

126. C 127. B 128. C 129. B 130. D 141. C 142. A 143. D 144. B 145. B

Hard

11. D 12. C 13. C 14. C 15. D 26. A 27. C 28. D 29. D 30. D

41. A 42. C 43. D 44. A 45. A 56. B 57. A 58. D 59. C 60. C

71. C 72. C 73. A 74. B 75. C 86. D 87. D 88. A 89. C 90. B

101. A 102. D 103. B 104. A 105. A 116. A 117. B 118. C 119. A 120. C

131. D 132. D 133. A 134. D 135. B 146. A 147. B 148. A 149. A 150. B